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Business Concept Training

Ghana | June 2024

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About the Trainers

Ato Ulzen-Appiah

Entrepreneurship Development Specialist, KIC

- (Social) entrepreneur, consultant, social media influencer and blogger.
- Consults in the youth, tech & agric spaces.
- Startup experience: Museke, Africa's Talking
- Professional experience: Google, Rancard, etc
- Director of the GhanaThink Foundation (social entreprise)
- On the advisory board for multiple African startups
- Coached & mentored several startups formally & through events
- & programs

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Key Components

- Background (Research)
- Problem
- Solution
- How It Works
- Innovation / Technology
- Collaborators & Partners
- Team

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Background / Research

The background should cover the following

- Causes of the problem
- The size of the market and the opportunity
- Value chain category and type
- Effects of the problem on the market
- Value proposition – benefits for the target market

Share some verifiable sources that have data that

- Supports your assertions
- Supports research findings

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The Problem

What is the problem in the market that you have identified?

A good Problem Statement is:

- **Short** – 1-2 sentences maximum
- **Specific** – clearly identifies what the problem is, the cause of the problem, and who has the problem
- Answers the question: So What?

Support your problem statement

- Examples of how the situation is “bad” now
- Use a personal story/anecdote to illustrate
- Quantitative – some statistics

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The Problem

X Slow and cost-ineffective manual harvesting. Physical damages to the crop that affect the economic value of the crop.

X There is a lack of adequate technical information in Ghana regarding proper farming, processing, and marketing.

X Farmers in Ghana find it challenging to identify genuine farm inputs.

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The Problem

✔

Young professionals, retirees, and members of the Ghanaian diaspora want to start agribusinesses as a secondary source of income. However, time constraints, middlemen, and limited access to information and inputs are major barriers to starting and running a new agribusiness.

✔

20% to 40% of agro-chemicals on the Ghanaian market are counterfeit. The average Ghanaian farmer can’t tell the difference between genuine and fake, and as a result, has lower than anticipated yields and suffers loss of income, while the agrochemical dealer (manufacturers and importers) records losses due to this same counterfeit battle.

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The Solution

- Kwidex enables financing options for agribusiness value chain actors through crowdfunding.

- Qualitrace: Building an anti-counterfeiting, verification and agro-input platform

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How It Works

- This shows how your business works - the process ----
- It should have a linkage with the problem and the solution
- Showcase how the customer interacts with the solution to the problem you are solving
- Focus on what your product does
- The audience for this is primarily your customer

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Technology / Innovation

- Share what is innovative about your proposed solution
- Share the differentiating factors between your solution and similar solutions
- Share how various technological platforms are used to deliver the proposed solution

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Collaborators & Partners

- Which organizations and partners would be important for this business idea?
- Talk about those you are in conversation with
- Mention any MOUs or agreements so far and what those are about
- Talk about how they are helping you cover an aspect of your business you cannot do yourself currently

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Team

- What is your name of the team?
- Who is on your team?
- What role do they play on the team?
- What skills, experience, and relationships do they contribute that are directly relevant to your business concept?

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Questions?